

05 - Front-End Implementation Brief and Codex Prompt Pack

[Front-end implementation brief](#) | [Build specification and prompts for Codex](#)

Formal name: Front-end implementation brief

Recommended technical direction

- Use a simple static-friendly site: Next.js App Router or Astro. If you are less comfortable, use Next.js because you already work with it.
- Use Tailwind CSS for fast implementation of the design tokens.
- Use MD/JSON data files for essays, projects, playlists, and Now updates. Do not hard-code repeatable cards.
- Do not create a CMS in version 1. Use local data files and simple components.
- External sources remain external: Substack, GitHub, Spotify, LinkedIn.

Suggested file structure

```
/src
/app
  page.tsx
  /writing/page.tsx
  /projects/page.tsx
  /now/page.tsx
  /about/page.tsx
/components
  Header.tsx
  Footer.tsx
  NorthNote.tsx
  EssayCard.tsx
  ProjectCard.tsx
  PlaylistCard.tsx
  NowCard.tsx
  SectionHeader.tsx
/data
  essays.ts
  projects.ts
  playlists.ts
  now.ts
/styles
  globals.css
/public
  /icons
  /images
```

Use this as production direction for design, content, and front-end implementation.

Design tokens for CSS/Tailwind

```
colors: {  
  moonstone: '#F4F5F8',  
  ink: '#243246',  
  fog: '#D9DFE8',  
  blueprint: '#5868F2',  
  slate: '#7087A0',  
  fjord: '#2F5D76',  
  iris: '#8B78B8'  
}  
font-family:  
  display: Fraunces or Cormorant Garamond, Georgia, serif  
  sans: Inter or Source Sans 3, system-ui, sans-serif  
  mono: IBM Plex Mono, Consolas, monospace
```

Codex prompt 1: project setup

You are building a personal authority website for Darwin Hernandez. Create a Next.js App Router project with Tailwind CSS. Implement a clean editorial design using the provided design tokens. Create routes for /, /writing, /projects, /now, and /about. Use local TypeScript data files for essays, projects, playlists, and now updates. Do not hard-code repeatable cards. Keep components small and readable.

Codex prompt 2: design system components

Create reusable components: Header, Footer, SectionHeader, NorthNote, EssayCard, ProjectCard, PlaylistCard, NowCard, and CTAButton. Use the Wayfinder identity: subtle compass/route/sprig motifs, soft blue/iris annotations, editorial spacing, and accessible semantic HTML. Keep the navigation simple: Writing, Projects, Now, About, Contact. Logo links to home.

Codex prompt 3: content data model

Create TypeScript data arrays for essays, projects, playlists, and now. Each essay must include title, subtitle, date, sourceUrl, summary, northSignal, whyItMatters, tags, featured, and optional relatedProjectSlug/relatedPlaylistSlug. Each project must include title, githubUrl, language, description, whatThisProves, builtWith, status, and featured. Then render these data-driven cards on the relevant pages.

Codex prompt 4: page build order

- Build Header/Footer first.
- Build Homepage using static sample data.
- Build Writing page with essay cards and Substack promo panel.
- Build Projects page with public repo cards.
- Build About page using preferred wireframe.
- Build Now page last.
- Run accessibility check: nav labels, link text, heading order, contrast, keyboard focus.

Definition of done

- Responsive at mobile, tablet, desktop.
- No lorem ipsum remains.
- All external links open correctly and have descriptive labels.
- Cards are rendered from data arrays.
- Dark mode toggle removed unless fully implemented.
- No page depends on unavailable APIs for initial render.
- The site feels editorial, useful, and not like a generic portfolio template.